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MKT 101: Principles of Marketing - Customers, Value and the Marketing Mix

Think like a marketer about real Nigerian markets, not just definitions

FACULTY PRIMER

Faculty Primer

Faculty of Management Sciences
Marketing | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

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Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Marketing is often reduced to advertising, which is like reducing medicine to injections. This pack explains value, exchange, segmentation, positioning and the extended marketing mix, using Nigerian campus and consumer examples you can analyse in assignments.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Define marketing as value creation and exchange rather than promotion alone.
- Segment a market and choose a defensible target segment and position.
- Apply the 4Ps and 7Ps to a real product or service.
- Explain consumer buying behaviour and the factors that shape it.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Marketing is not advertising

Marketing begins with understanding a need and ends with a satisfied customer, profitably.

- Needs are basic requirements; wants are culturally shaped desires; demand is the willingness and ability to buy.
- Value is the difference between what a customer gets and what they give up.
- Exchange requires two parties, something of value, communication and freedom to accept or reject.
- Marketing orientation starts with the customer; production orientation starts with the factory.
- Customer satisfaction and retention are cheaper than constant acquisition.

- Marketing ethics matter: manipulation and false claims destroy trust and invite regulation.

STP: segment, target, position

You cannot serve everybody well. Choose deliberately.

1. Segment the market using demographic, geographic, psychographic or behavioural variables.
2. Evaluate segments by size, growth, profitability, accessibility and fit with your capability.
3. Select one or more target segments and state why.
4. Choose a positioning statement: for whom, what benefit, against which alternative.
5. Test the positioning for clarity, credibility and distinctiveness.
6. Ensure the marketing mix actually delivers the promised position.

> **Positioning is a promise**
> If you position on low price, your cost structure must support it. If you position on quality, your product and service must consistently prove it.

The marketing mix and consumer behaviour

The mix is the set of controllable tools used to deliver value in the target market.

- Product: features, quality, branding, packaging, after-sales service.
- Price: cost-plus, value-based, penetration and skimming strategies.
- Place: channels, coverage, logistics and retailer relationships.
- Promotion: advertising, sales promotion, public relations, personal selling and digital marketing.
- For services, extend with people, process and physical evidence.
- Buying behaviour is shaped by culture, social groups, personal factors and psychological factors such as perception and motivation.

Marketing is exchange, not advertising

Marketing is the activity of creating, communicating and delivering value to a chosen market at a profit. Advertising is one tool within it. A business that advertises a product nobody wants has a marketing failure, not an advertising one.

The marketing concept holds that the customer's need should organise the business, subject to profitability. This is not altruism: it is a claim about which orientation survives competition. Production orientation assumes supply is the constraint; product orientation assumes quality sells itself; selling orientation assumes persuasion is the constraint; marketing orientation assumes understanding the customer is.

The marketing environment is analysed with PESTLE (political, economic, social, technological, legal, environmental) and with Porter's five forces for competitive pressure. These frameworks are only useful if you fill them with specific facts about a specific market.

Segmentation, targeting and positioning

Markets are not homogeneous. Segmentation divides a market by measurable and actionable criteria: demographic, geographic, psychographic and behavioural. A segment is useful only if it can be reached and served profitably.

Targeting chooses which segments to serve; positioning decides the place the offer should occupy in the customer's mind relative to alternatives. A positioning statement names the target, the category, the benefit and the reason to believe - and a version that could describe a competitor is not a positioning statement.

The marketing mix operationalises the choice: product (features, quality, branding, packaging), price (level, discounts, terms), place (channels, coverage, logistics) and promotion (advertising, sales promotion, public relations, personal selling, digital). In services, people, process and physical evidence extend the mix.

> **One sentence first**
> Write: "For [target] who [need], our offer is a [category] that [benefit], unlike [alternative]." If you cannot fill it, the plan is not yet a plan.

Consumer behaviour and the Nigerian market

Buying decisions involve need recognition, information search, evaluation, purchase and post-purchase behaviour. The process is compressed for habitual purchases and extended for expensive or risky ones. Marketers influence each stage differently; a single message cannot do all the work.

Nigerian consumer markets are shaped by income volatility, informal retail, strong social networks, religious and festive calendars, and rapid mobile adoption. Distribution through kiosks, markets and agents often beats formal retail. Trust is built through community reference, not only through branded advertising.

Marketing ethics matter practically. Misleading claims, exploitative pricing and dark patterns destroy trust in markets where reputation travels fast. Regulation exists - advertising standards, consumer protection - and non-compliance carries commercial as well as legal cost.

WORKED EXAMPLES

Do it once, slowly

These are not model answers to copy. They show the reasoning a strong student would use, step by step, so you can repeat the process on a question you have not seen.

1. Writing a positioning statement

A campus food vendor wants to compete with cheaper street food.

1. Identify target: students who skip breakfast before 8 a.m. lectures.
2. Identify need: fast, filling, hygienic food within walking distance.
3. Choose category: quick-service breakfast.
4. Choose benefit: ready in three minutes, sealed packaging.
5. Choose reason to believe: pre-packed portions and a visible kitchen.
6. Write the statement and test whether it could describe the cheaper competitor.

> **What to carry forward**
> Positioning fails when the benefit is what everyone claims. Choose something a rival cannot easily copy.

2. Setting a price with three methods

Price a handmade leather bag.

1. Cost-plus: total cost 8,000, add 40 per cent margin, giving 11,200.
2. Competitor-based: comparable bags retail at 10,000 to 14,000.
3. Value-based: estimate what the target customer will pay for durability and design.
4. Reconcile: choose a figure that covers cost and sits credibly against alternatives.
5. State the assumption that would change the answer, such as a rise in leather prices.

> **What to carry forward**
> Use all three methods; each corrects the blind spot of the others.

EXAM TECHNIQUE

Questions with model answers

Written in the shape your course is usually examined, with the marking logic spelled out. Attempt each one under time before you read the outline.

Q1. Explain the four Ps and how they must be consistent with each other.

15 marks

1. Define product, price, place and promotion.
2. Show a consistency example: premium product requires premium price and selective distribution.
3. Show an inconsistency and its cost.
4. Conclude that the mix is a system, not a checklist.

Q2. Distinguish segmentation, targeting and positioning.

10 marks

1. Segmentation divides the market.
2. Targeting selects which segments to serve.
3. Positioning decides the intended place in the customer's mind.
4. Give a short example running through all three.

REFERENCE

Glossary

Use these definitions in your own sentences; a copied definition rarely earns full marks.

Marketing mix. The controllable elements - product, price, place, promotion - used to serve a target market.

Segmentation. Dividing a market into groups with shared characteristics.

Targeting. Selecting the segments a business will serve.

Positioning. The place an offer is designed to occupy in the customer's mind.

Value proposition. The specific benefit an offer promises and why it is credible.

PESTLE. A framework for analysing the macro-environment.

Distribution channel. The route by which a product reaches the customer.

Brand equity. The added value a brand name gives to a product.

Customer lifetime value. The total profit expected from a customer over the relationship.

Market orientation. Organising the business around understanding and serving customer needs.

Push and pull. Promotion through channel incentives versus demand creation with end customers.

Consumer protection. Law and regulation guarding buyers against unfair or unsafe practices.

Your four-week plan

Week 1 - Concepts

Orientation.

- Distinguish the four orientations with examples.
- Complete a PESTLE for one industry.
- Write a one-sentence value proposition.

Week 2 - STP

Choice.

- Segment a market on three bases.
- Choose a target and justify it.
- Write and test a positioning statement.

Week 3 - Mix

Execution.

- Design a four-P plan for one product.
- Price it three ways.
- Check internal consistency.

Week 4 - Behaviour

Customers.

- Map a purchase decision process.
- Identify two Nigerian market factors.
- Assess one ethical issue.

Where to read more

Entry-level texts you can find in the university library or a departmental reading list. Confirm editions with your lecturer.

- Any principles of marketing textbook covering STP and the marketing mix.
- A consumer behaviour text with emerging-market case studies.
- Nigerian advertising and consumer protection regulation summaries.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Distinguish a need from a want.

Answer: A need is a basic requirement such as food. A want is a culturally shaped way of satisfying it, such as a specific brand of noodles.

2. What is market segmentation?

Answer: Dividing a heterogeneous market into smaller groups of buyers with similar needs or characteristics that can be served with a tailored offer.

3. Give two pricing strategies and when each is appropriate.

Answer: Price skimming suits an innovative product with early adopters. Penetration pricing suits a new entrant trying to win share quickly.

4. Why do services add people, process and physical evidence to the 4Ps?

Answer: Because services are intangible, produced and consumed simultaneously, and dependent on staff and customer experience, so these elements shape perceived quality.

5. Write a positioning statement for a campus food vendor.

Answer: For busy UNIZIK students who need affordable, quick meals, our vendor offers hot home-style food delivered to hostels within 20 minutes, unlike cafeteria queues.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Define marketing, needs, wants and demand in your own words.
- [ ] Segment the UNIZIK student market in three different ways.
- [ ] Write one positioning statement for a product you use.
- [ ] Apply all seven Ps to a service business near campus.
- [ ] Collect two adverts and identify the targeting and positioning used.
- [ ] Explain three psychological factors in buying decisions.
- [ ] Write a one-page marketing mix proposal for a student business idea.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date: